In order for sustainable changes in the use of landmines to occur, this chapter argues broader engagement at local levels will be necessary. Those seeking to engage conflict-affected communities will achieve more with approaches that acknowledge chronic insecurity and recognize the agency present in Myanmar's conflict-affected communities, including the capacity for a community's own militarized responses to prevailing conditions. In so doing, the promotion of non-military strategies will be critical to draw communities, armed actors, and local power brokers together. Promoting trust in interim governance institutions under the NCA that can build physical, psychological, and environmental security will be critical to successful behavioural change. Such an approach can produce not only a reduction in landmine use, but can build further legitimacy in local governance reforms.

INTERNATIONAL LAW AND DE-MINING IN MYANMAR

While the government of Myanmar is not a signatory to the tripartite conventions on conventional weapons, landmines and cluster munitions, the United Nations Committee on the Rights of the Child requested it take appropriate actions to protect children from the dangers of landmines (UN CRC 2012, p. 2). In response, the Department of Social Welfare established a Mine Risk Education Working Group (MRE WG) as a cross-ministerial body together with representatives from international and local organizations, yet with little representation from EAGs. For reasons explained below, this body has had limited impact in engaging parties in bilateral and national ceasefire processes on the issue of landmines, remaining focused on a core mandate of risk education and behavioural change.

Currently, five ceasefires, including two with the Karen National Union (KNU), state and Union level, have included de-mining or the consideration of broader mine action within their texts (Min Zaw Oo 2014).[4] However, EAGs in Myanmar are ineligible to ratify international laws. Nevertheless, they are often interested in bringing focus on their efforts to protect the rights of populations living within their administration areas. One initiative from Geneva Call, an INGO working specifically with non-state actors, is deeds of commitment. As discussed below, these provide EAGs with the opportunity to highlight their recognition of humanitarian norms on the use of landmines, as well as the protection of children and women in conflict.[5]